L Learners Coach

Sign meanings

Must-know signs per session, with their meanings (DoT Manual on Road Traffic Signs).

Session 2: Regulatory signs 1: control, command and prohibition

Stop sign	Stop completely at the line or in line with the sign, then go only when safe
4-way stop	All four directions must stop; the first to stop goes first
Yield sign	Give way to other traffic; stop only if you have to
Yield to pedestrians	Give way to pedestrians crossing or about to cross
No entry	You may not enter this road
One-way roadway	Traffic may only travel in the direction of the arrow
Pedestrian priority	Pedestrians have priority; vehicles may enter only for set reasons and very slowly
Yield to oncoming traffic	Give way to oncoming traffic on the narrow section ahead
Minimum speed	Do not drive slower than the speed shown
Keep left / keep right	Pass the obstruction on the side the arrow points to
Proceed in one direction only	At the junction ahead you may only go in the direction shown
Turn left or right only	You must turn in the direction shown
Pedestrians only	Only pedestrians may use this path
Buses only	Only buses may use this road or lane
Switch headlamps on	You must switch your headlights on (dipped)
Roundabout	Drive clockwise around the roundabout
Excessive noise prohibited	Do not hoot or make unnecessary noise
No left or right turn ahead	You may not turn left (or right) at the junction ahead
U-turn prohibited	You may not make a U-turn
Overtaking prohibited	No overtaking of motor vehicles for the next 500 m
Parking prohibited	No parking; you may stop briefly to load or drop off
Stopping prohibited	You may not stop at all, except in an emergency or when traffic forces you to
Pedestrians prohibited	No pedestrians allowed

Session 3: Regulatory signs 2: reservation, limits and plates

Speed limit	Do not drive faster than the speed shown
Mass limit	Vehicles heavier than the mass shown may not enter
Height limit	Vehicles higher than the height shown may not enter

Width limit	Vehicles wider than the width shown may not enter
Bus reservation	The roadway (R) or parking (P) is reserved for buses
Bus lane reservation	This lane is reserved for buses
Parking reservation	Parking is allowed here; a time shown limits how long you may stay
Bus stop reservation	Only buses may stop here, to pick up or set down passengers
Dual-carriageway freeway begins	Freeway rules start here (dual carriageway)
Woonerf (residential area)	Residential area: pedestrians have right of way and the limit is 30 km/h
De-restriction	The restriction shown on the sign has ended
Time plate	The sign above applies only during the times shown
Maximum stay plate	Do not stop or park longer than the time shown during these periods
Daytime plate	The sign above applies only during the day
Night time plate	The sign above applies only at night
Direction plate	The sign above applies only to traffic going in the arrow's direction

Session 4: Traffic signals and hand signals

Overhead green arrow	You may drive in the lane below the arrow
Overhead red cross	You may not drive in the lane below the cross
Overhead yellow arrow	Your lane is closed ahead: move over in the arrow's direction
Officer: one arm raised	Traffic approaching from the front must stop
Officer: arm out, back to you	Traffic approaching from the rear must stop
Officer: both arms out	Traffic from the front and the rear must stop
Officer: go signal (d)	You may proceed
Officer: go signal (e)	You may proceed
Flag signals: stop and proceed	Stop when the flag signals stop; go only when the proceed signal is given
Warning flag signal	Slow down and proceed with care

Session 5: Warning signs and hazard plates

Crossroad	Crossroad ahead
Priority crossroad	Crossroad ahead; you are on the main road with right of way
T-junction	T-junction ahead; the road ends and you must turn
Y-junction	The road splits in two ahead
Traffic circle ahead	Traffic circle ahead: slow down and be ready to yield
Sharp curve	Sharp bend ahead: slow down
Two-way traffic	The one-way road becomes two-way: keep left

Lane ends	The lane ends ahead: move over in good time
Traffic signals ahead	Traffic lights ahead
Stop sign ahead	Stop sign ahead that you may not see in time
Yield sign ahead	Yield sign ahead that you may not see in time
Scholar patrol ahead	Scholar patrol ahead: be ready to stop
Pedestrian crossing ahead	Pedestrian crossing ahead
Pedestrians	Pedestrians may be on or next to the road
Children	Children may be on or next to the road, for example near a school
Railway crossing ahead	Railway level crossing ahead
Tunnel	Tunnel ahead: switch headlights on, do not overtake
Steep hill	Steep climb or steep descent ahead: use a lower gear
Road works	Road works ahead
General warning	Danger ahead; a plate below may say what it is
Danger plate	Pass the hazard on the side the arrowhead points to
Sharp curve chevron	Sharp bend in the direction the chevrons point
T-junction chevron	The road ends at a T-junction: turn left or right

Session 6: Information and guidance signs

Exit countdown	Each bar is 100 m to the exit
Cul-de-sac	No through road
Right of way	You are on the priority road at the junction ahead
Supplementary plates	Extra information for the sign above, such as distance or vehicle type
Confirmation sign	Confirms the route you are on and the distances to towns
Pre-advance exit direction	Freeway exit about 2 km ahead
Advance exit direction	Freeway exit about 1 km ahead
Supplementary exit direction	Freeway exit about 500 m ahead: be in the left lane
Exit direction	The freeway exit is here
Advance trailblazer	Shows the turn to take to reach a route or freeway
Lanes merge (diagram)	A lane merges with another ahead
Engage lower gear	Steep descent: change to a lower gear

Session 7: Road surface markings

Stop line	Stop with your vehicle behind this line
Yield line	Give way to everyone crossing in front of you here
Pedestrian crossing	Give way to pedestrians crossing or about to cross
No overtaking line	Do not drive on the right of this solid line

No crossing line	You may not cross this line
Channelising line	You may not cross this line into the other channel
Edge lines	Show the left and right edge of the road
Painted island	Do not drive in this painted area
Parking bay	You may park in this bay
Exclusive parking bay	Parking only for the users shown, such as buses or taxis
Mandatory direction arrows	From this lane you may only go the way the arrow points
Box junction	Do not stop inside the yellow box
No stopping line	You may not stop next to this red line
No parking line	You may not park next to this yellow line
Traffic circle arrows	The direction you must follow around the circle
Continuity lines	Your lane may become an exit or turning lane at the break ahead
Dividing line	Traffic on the other side of the line comes towards you
Lane lines	Separate lanes of traffic going the same way